

Sermon Notes: The Gift of Salvation **Title:** Embracing Eternal Life: Understanding God's Plan of Salvation
Scripture Focus: [Romans 10:9-10](#) - ⁹ *That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved.* ¹⁰ *For with the heart believeth unto righteousness; and with the mouth confession is made unto salvation.* (NIV) - "If you confess with your mouth, 'Jesus is Lord,' and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved. For it is with your heart that you believe and are justified, and it is with your mouth that you profess your faith and are saved." **Introduction (Approx. 1/4 page)** - **Hook:** Begin with a personal story or question to engage the congregation. E.g., "Have you ever felt lost in a storm, desperate for rescue? That's the human condition without salvation – adrift in sin, but God offers a lifeline." - **Define Salvation:** Salvation is God's rescue plan from sin, death, and eternal separation. It's not earned but gifted through faith in Jesus Christ. Reference [Ephesians 2:8-9](#) - ⁸ *For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God:* ⁹ *Not of works, lest any man should boast.* (NIV): "For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith—and this is not from yourselves, it is the gift of God—not by works, so that no one can boast." - **Purpose of Sermon:** Today, we'll explore why we need salvation, how it's achieved, and what it means for our lives and open hearts. **Main Body Point 1: The Need for Salvation (Approx. 1/2 page)** - **Humanity's Fallen State:** From the beginning, sin entered through Adam and Eve, separating us from God. [Genesis 3:23](#) - ²³ *The Lord God sent him forth from the garden of Eden, to till the ground from whence he was taken.* (NIV) "The Lord God banished him from the Garden of Eden to work the ground from which he had been taken." Original sin affects all – we're born into it. - **Consequences of Sin:** Without salvation, we face spiritual death and judgment. [Romans 3:23](#) - ²³ *For all have sinned, and come short of the glory of God;* (NIV): "For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God." And [Romans 6:23](#) - ²³ *For the wages of sin is death; but the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.* (NIV): "For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord." - **Illustration:** Compare to a drowning person – we can't save ourselves; we need a savior. Share a brief testimony or analogy of someone realizing their need for God. - **Application:** Encourage self-reflection: "Examine your life – where has sin led you astray? Salvation starts with acknowledging this need." **Main Body Point 2: God's Provision for Salvation (Approx. 3/4 page)** - **The Promise in the Old Testament:** God foreshadowed salvation through prophecies and sacrifices. [Isaiah 53:5-6](#) - ⁵ *But he was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities: the chastisement of our peace was upon him; and with his stripes we are healed.* ⁶ *All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned every one to his own way; and the Lord hath laid on him the iniquity of us all.* (NIV): "But he was pierced for our transgressions; he was crushed for our iniquities; the punishment that brought us peace was on him, and by his wounds we are healed. We all, like sheep, have gone astray, each of us has turned to our own way; and the Lord has laid on him the iniquity of us all." This points to the coming Messiah. - **Jesus as the Savior:** God sent His Son to save the world. [John 3:16-17](#) - ¹⁶ *For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believes in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.* ¹⁷ *For God sent not his Son into the world to condemn the world; but that the world through him might be saved.* (NIV): "For God so loved the world that he gave his only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life. For God did not send his Son into the world to condemn the world, but to save the world through him." - **The Cross and Resurrection:** Jesus' death paid the penalty for sin; His resurrection defeated death. [1 Corinthians 15:3-4](#) - ³ *For I delivered unto you first of all that which I also received, how that Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures: And that he was buried, and that he rose again the third day according to the scriptures:* (NIV): "For I delivered to you first of all that which I also received, how that Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures. And that he was buried, and that he rose again the third day according to the scriptures."

received I passed on to you as of first importance: that Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures was buried, that he was raised on the third day according to the Scriptures." - ****Exclusivity of Salvation other way – [Acts 4:12](#) - ¹² Neither is there salvation in any other: for there is none other name under given among men, whereby we must be saved.**" (NIV): "Salvation is found in no one else, for there is no name under heaven given to mankind by which we must be saved." - ****Illustration:**** Use the bridge as it creates a chasm between us and God; Jesus' cross bridges it. - ****Application:**** "Believe in Jesus – not just intellectually, but with your whole heart. Confess Him as Lord." ****Main Body Point 3: Living Out Salvation (1/2 page)**** - ****Transformation Through Faith:**** Salvation changes us from inside out. [2 Corinthians 5: Therefore if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature: old things are passed away; behold, all things become new.](#) (NIV): "Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come: The old has gone, the new is here!" - ****Assurance and Eternal Security:**** Once saved, we're sealed by the Holy Spirit. [John 10:28-29 I give unto them eternal life; and they shall never perish, neither shall any man pluck them out of my Father's hand.](#) (NIV): "I give them eternal life, and they shall never perish; no one will snatch them out of my hand. My Father, who has given them to me, is greater than all; no one can snatch them out of my Father's hand." - ****From Faith to Works:**** Good works follow faith, not precede it. [James 2:26 - ²⁶ For as the body without the spirit is dead, so faith without works is dead also.](#) (NIV): "As the body without the spirit is dead, so faith without works is dead." Encourage evangelism, service, and holy living. - ****Illustration:**** Story of the prodigal son ([Luke 15:11-32](#)) - ****Application:**** "Share your faith – tell others about this gift. Live daily in gratitude, avoiding sin through the power of the Holy Spirit." ****Conclusion (Approx. 1/4 page)**** - ****Summarize Key Points:**** We need salvation due to our sin.

provides it through Jesus; we live it out in faith and works. - ****Call to Action:**** Invite response – "If you accepted Christ, do so today. Pray with me: 'Lord Jesus, I confess my sins and believe in You. Save me.'"

****Benediction:**** Close with [Titus 3:5-7](#) - ⁵ *Not by works of righteousness which we have done, but at his mercy he saved us, by the washing of regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost;* ⁶ *Which he saved us abundantly through Jesus Christ our Saviour;* ⁷ *That being justified by his grace, we should be made according to the hope of eternal life.*" (NIV): "He saved us, not because of righteous things we had done because of his mercy. He saved us through the washing of rebirth and renewal by the Holy Spirit, whom he poured out on us generously through Jesus Christ our Savior, so that, having been justified by his grace, we might become heirs having the hope of eternal life." - ****Final Prayer and Dismissal:**** Pray for the Work root then dismiss with a blessing check in